

Layered Feature Story - Report Log

Project summary

- Topic: My Coffee Ritual
- Repository: Layered-Feature-Story
- Story structure: 1 main title, 4 section headings, about 700 words
- Main sections: Making It at Home; Coffee Changes With the Seasons; Trying Something New; Why the Ritual Matters

Composition Plan

Element	Purpose	Technique	Decision / reason	Fallback / test
.issue-badge	Anchored label in the feature header	Absolute positioning inside .feature-header, which is position: relative	Keeps the Daily Ritual label in the top-right without pushing title/intro	Check long title, 320px, and zoom for overlap
.story-guide	Section navigation	Sticky on wider screens only	Keeps section links available while reading; returns to normal flow below 52rem	Sticky start and boundary test passed
.pull-quote	Editorial emphasis	Relative positioning + raised layer + negative margin	Kept the overlap subtle; changed margin-inline-start from -4rem to -1rem	Overlap looked cleaner and stayed readable
.feature-figure	Feature image/caption group	Rounded container	Changed border-radius to 1rem for a softer card treatment	Rectangular fallback remains complete
.feature-figure img	Decorative/media enhancement	clip-path ellipse	Changed starter polygon to ellipse(50% 48% at 50% 50%) because polygon felt too harsh	clip-path fallback tested in DevTools
.shape-portrait	Editorial image wrap	float + shape-outside + shape-margin on wide screens	Text wraps around a circular shape on large screens; narrow screens return to normal flow	shape-outside fallback tested in DevTools

Layer / z-index notes

- --layer-base: 0
- --layer-raised: 10
- --layer-sticky: 20
- --layer-overlay: 30
- .pull-quote uses var(--layer-raised) = 10
- .story-guide uses var(--layer-sticky) = 20
- No arbitrary giant z-index values were found.
- The clipped feature image has an active clip-path and therefore creates its own stacking context.

Testing record

Test	Result	What I observed
320px viewport	Passed	Layout remained readable; shape portrait disengaged to normal flow.
768px viewport	Passed	Layout remained readable.
1280px viewport	Passed	Desktop grid and enhanced layout looked correct.
200% zoom	Passed	Text reflowed and focus remained visible.
Keyboard focus	Passed	Story-guide links had visible focus.
Long-title growth	Passed	Long temporary title wrapped without clipping or badge overlap; also checked at 320px.
Doubled paragraph	Passed	Section grew naturally without overlap.

Sticky behavior	Passed	Story guide stuck at desktop width and stayed bounded.
Layered link pointer activation	Passed	All story-guide links worked with mouse and keyboard.
clip-path disabled	Passed	Feature image returned to a rectangle and content remained usable.
shape-outside disabled	Passed	Portrait stayed floated and text wrapped around its rectangular box.
Stacking-context inspection	Passed	Checked sticky guide, pull quote, and clipped image in DevTools; no unexpected overlap.
HTML validation	Completed	No errors; one warning that the article element lacks its own heading.
CSS validation	Completed	Validator flagged shape-outside and shape-margin; both were verified with MDN and tested successfully in Chrome.

Evidence filenames

- viewport-320px.png
- viewport-768px.png
- viewport-1280px.png
- zoom-200-percent.png
- keyboard-focus.png
- sticky-active.png
- sticky-boundary.png
- long-title-test.png
- doubled-paragraph-test.png
- clip-path-fallback.png
- shape-outside-fallback.png
- html-validation.png
- css-validation.png

MDN Resource

- border-radius: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/Properties/border-radius>
- clip-path: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/Properties/clip-path>
- shape-outside: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/Properties/shape-outside>
- shape-margin: <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/Properties/shape-margin>

Validator note: The CSS validator flagged shape-outside and shape-margin, but the assignment requires these properties, MDN documents them, and both were tested successfully in Chrome. The HTML checker showed one warning about the article element lacking its own heading, but no HTML errors.

AI Disclosure

Shape coordinates: ChatGPT suggested shape options for the feature image. The polygon option felt too harsh, so I chose an ellipse and used ellipse(50% 48% at 50% 50%). I verified clip-path syntax with MDN and tested the result in Chrome. I kept the ellipse because it was noticeable without feeling too dramatic.

Debugging hypotheses: ChatGPT helped suggest what to inspect while checking the sticky guide, pull-quote overlap, and stacking behavior. I checked computed position, z-index, and active clip-path values in DevTools and made decisions based on what I actually observed. I changed the pull-quote overlap from -4rem to -1rem because the smaller overlap looked better.

Assets

- feature.jpg — Photo by Kadir Celep on Unsplash.
- portrait.jpg — Photo by Travis Beck on Unsplash.
- Story text — Original writing by me.

Code Defense

- **Grid layout:** I used CSS Grid for the main page layout because the assignment requires primary regions to be handled with Grid or Flexbox instead of positioning.
- **Sticky story guide:** I used position: sticky only on larger screens so the navigation stays available while reading but returns to normal flow on smaller screens.
- **Anchored detail:** The badge uses position: absolute inside the relatively positioned header, so it stays anchored to that section instead of the whole page.
- **Pull quote overlap:** I used a small negative margin and a raised layer to create a controlled overlap without removing the quote from normal flow.
- **Layer system:** I used named z-index tokens like raised and sticky instead of arbitrary large values.
- **Rounded treatment:** The feature figure uses border-radius as a simple baseline shape treatment.
- **Clipped image:** I used an elliptical clip-path on the feature image because I preferred a softer shape over the starter polygon.
- **Editorial wrap:** The portrait uses float, shape-outside, and shape-margin so text wraps around the image on wider screens.
- **Fallbacks:** When clip-path or shape-outside is disabled, the content is still complete and readable.
- **Responsive behavior:** The layout was tested at 320px, 768px, 1280px, and 200% zoom.
- **Accessibility:** I checked keyboard focus, reading order, and made sure no focusable content was clipped or blocked by layered elements.
- **Validation:** HTML had no errors and one article-heading warning. The CSS validator flagged shape-outside and shape-margin, but both were verified with MDN and tested successfully in Chrome.